
John Tavener

1944–2013, BRITISH

Tavener enjoyed great success with spiritual, meditative works that appealed to many people who were not generally interested in modern music. He made an early impact with *The Whale* (admired by The Beatles and recorded on their Apple label) and his striking appearance (he was extremely tall, with long, flowing hair) helped keep him in the public eye. In 1977, he was received by the Russian Orthodox Church. His music was deeply influenced by its traditions, using simple motifs to create a mood of intense contemplation. His fame soared when *Song for Athene* (written in tribute to a friend of that name who died in a road accident) was performed at the funeral of Diana, Princess of Wales, in 1997. Most of Tavener's work is choral, but *The Protecting Veil* for cello and strings is one of his most acclaimed compositions.

KEY WORKS: *The Whale*, 1966; *The Lamb*, 1982; *The Protecting Veil*, 1988; *Song for Athene*, 1993

Alexina Louie